

Representative FAQ

Frequently Asked Questions | Quick Reference | Plan Year 2026

This document contains answers to the most common policy questions raised during customer conversations.

For questions not covered here, consult the full policy documents:

[Plan Benefits Guide \(MH-BRO-2026-047\)](#) | [Terms & Conditions \(MH-TC-2026-047\)](#)

[Exclusion Reference \(MH-EXC-2026-047\)](#) | [Claim Process Guide \(MH-CPG-2026-047\)](#)

Frequently Asked Questions

This FAQ covers the most common questions representatives encounter during customer conversations. Each answer is sourced from MeridianHealth's official plan documents. For detailed policy provisions, exclusions, or edge cases not addressed here, refer to the companion documents listed on the cover page or contact the back-office helpdesk at extension 4400.

FAQ-01

Q: What are the copay amounts for a primary care visit under each plan tier?

A: Primary care visit copays for in-network providers are: Bronze — \$45, Silver — \$35, Gold — \$25, and Platinum — \$15. These copays apply before the deductible is met. Out-of-network primary care visits are subject to the out-of-network deductible and 50% coinsurance instead of a flat copay.

FAQ-02

Q: Is there a waiting period for pre-existing conditions on ACA-compliant plans?

A: No. Under the Affordable Care Act, all MeridianHealth ACA-compliant plans — including Individual, Family, and Employer-Sponsored plans across all four metal tiers — cover pre-existing conditions from the first day of coverage. There is no waiting period, no health questionnaire, and no premium surcharge based on health status. This applies to all conditions including diabetes, hypertension, asthma, cancer history, heart disease, and mental health conditions.

FAQ-03

Q: What prescription drug tiers does MeridianHealth use and what are the copays?

A: MeridianHealth uses a four-tier formulary. Tier 1 (generic drugs): \$10 copay per 30-day retail fill, \$25 for 90-day mail order. Tier 2 (preferred brand): \$35 retail, \$87.50 mail order. Tier 3 (non-preferred brand): \$70 retail, \$175 mail order. Tier 4 (specialty): 30% coinsurance up to a maximum of \$300 per fill, not available by mail order. Specialty medications require prior authorization and must be dispensed through MeridianHealth's specialty pharmacy partner.

FAQ-04

Q: How do I file a reimbursement claim for out-of-network services?

A: To file a reimbursement claim: (1) Collect all itemized bills, receipts, and medical records from the provider, ensuring they include provider name, address, TIN, member name, dates of service, ICD-10 diagnosis codes, CPT/HCPSCS procedure codes, and itemized charges. (2) Complete Form MH-RC-200, available at www.meridianhealth.example.com/forms. (3) Submit the form and documents to MeridianHealth Claims Department, P.O. Box 5500, Hartford, CT 06102-5500, or electronically via the member portal, or by fax to (860) 555-0177. (4) Claims are processed within 30 calendar days of receiving a complete submission. Payment is made by direct deposit or check.

FAQ-05

Q: What is the deadline for submitting a reimbursement claim?

A: Reimbursement claims for the base medical plan must be submitted within 90 calendar days of the date of service. Claims submitted after 90 days but within 12 months may be accepted only if timely filing was not reasonably possible (e.g., the member was incapacitated). Claims submitted more than 12 months after the date of service will not be processed under any circumstances.

FAQ-06

Q: Does MeridianHealth cover emergency room visits at out-of-network hospitals?

A: Yes. Emergency services are covered at the in-network cost-sharing rate at any licensed emergency facility, regardless of whether the hospital is in MeridianHealth's network. This is required under the No Surprises Act. The member will not be balance-billed for amounts exceeding the in-network allowed amount for emergency services. If the member is admitted directly from the emergency room, the ER copay is waived and inpatient hospital benefits apply. Notify MeridianHealth within 48 hours of admission by calling (800) 555-0188.

FAQ-07

Q: What is the annual out-of-pocket maximum for Plan Year 2026?

A: The annual out-of-pocket maximum (OOP max) for in-network services varies by plan tier: Bronze — \$9,450 individual / \$18,900 family; Silver — \$8,200 / \$16,400; Gold — \$6,800 / \$13,600; Platinum — \$3,500 / \$7,000. All amounts are at or below the federal ACA ceiling of \$10,600 (individual) / \$21,200 (family) for 2026. The OOP max includes deductibles, copays, and coinsurance for in-network covered services. Premiums and out-of-network costs do not count toward the in-network OOP max.

FAQ-08

Q: Are mental health and substance use disorder services covered?

A: Yes. Outpatient mental health therapy sessions are covered at the specialist copay rate under all ACA-compliant plans. Inpatient behavioral health and substance use disorder treatment is covered at the same coinsurance rate as medical/surgical inpatient stays, in compliance with the Mental Health Parity and Addiction Equity Act. Prior authorization is required for residential treatment programs exceeding 14 consecutive days. Inpatient substance use rehabilitation is limited to 2 admissions per plan year, 30 days each.

FAQ-09

Q: What documents do I need to present for a cashless claim at an in-network provider?

A: For a cashless claim at an in-network facility, the member needs to present: (1) their MeridianHealth Member ID card, and (2) a government-issued photo ID. If the service requires prior authorization, the prior authorization approval must also be on file. The provider handles all claim submission paperwork directly with MeridianHealth. The member pays only the applicable copay or coinsurance at the time of service.

FAQ-10

Q: How does the Supplemental Shield waiting period work for illness-related claims?

A: The Supplemental Shield plan has a 90-day waiting period for illness-related claims from the policy effective date. During the first 90 days, claims arising from illness, disease, or non-accidental medical conditions are not payable. This includes Hospital Confinement Indemnity, ICU Confinement Indemnity, and Critical Illness benefits when triggered by illness. Accident-related claims have no waiting period and are eligible from the policy effective date.

FAQ-11

Q: Is cosmetic surgery covered under MeridianHealth plans?

A: No. Cosmetic surgery and procedures performed primarily to improve appearance are permanently excluded under all MeridianHealth plans. This includes rhinoplasty, liposuction, abdominoplasty, breast augmentation for cosmetic purposes, hair transplantation, and chemical peels. Exception: Reconstructive surgery following a covered accident, injury, or mastectomy is covered under ACA plans per the Women's Health and Cancer Rights Act. Reconstructive surgery for congenital anomalies in dependents under age 19 is also covered.

FAQ-12

Q: What is prior authorization and which services require it?

A: Prior authorization is advance approval from MeridianHealth's Utilization Management department before certain services are rendered. Services requiring prior authorization include: inpatient hospital admissions (except emergency), outpatient surgery with estimated charges exceeding \$2,500, advanced imaging (MRI, CT, PET scans), specialty medications on Tier 4, infertility treatments, bariatric surgery, residential treatment programs, and durable medical equipment exceeding \$1,000 in cost. Submit Form MH-PA-100 with clinical documentation. MeridianHealth responds within 5 business days for standard requests and 72 hours for urgent requests. Failure to obtain required prior authorization may result in a 30% reduction in benefits.

FAQ-13

Q: How do I appeal a denied claim?

A: File an internal appeal within 180 calendar days of the denial notice by submitting Form MH-APL-400 along with any supporting documentation. MeridianHealth will issue a decision within 30 calendar days for pre-service claims and 60 calendar days for post-service claims. Urgent appeals receive a decision within 72 hours. If the internal appeal is denied, the member may request an external review by an independent review organization within 4 months. The external review decision is binding on MeridianHealth and there is no cost to the member.

FAQ-14

Q: Are pediatric dental and vision services covered?

A: Yes. Pediatric dental and vision services are covered as Essential Health Benefits for dependents under age 19 under all ACA-compliant plans. Dental benefits include two preventive visits per year and basic restorative services. Medically necessary orthodontia is covered up to a \$2,000 lifetime maximum. Vision benefits include one annual eye exam and one pair of corrective lenses or contact lens allowance per plan year.

FAQ-15

Q: What happens if I miss a premium payment?

A: MeridianHealth provides a 31-day grace period for premium payment. Members receiving an Advance Premium Tax Credit (APTC) receive a 90-day grace period. During the first 30 days of the grace period, MeridianHealth continues to pay claims normally. During days 31 through 90 (for APTC recipients), claims may be held pending and providers may be notified. If premiums are not paid by the end of the grace period, coverage is terminated retroactively to the last day of the last month for which premiums were fully paid.